

IBM Scout

Sales Content Optimization & Utility Tool

IBM Scout is a federated-provenance knowledge graph that turns scattered CRM, Passport Advantage, w3 and partner data into proactive seller intelligence - built with IBM Bob, powered by watsonx.ai Granite.

The problem

An IBM seller's context is fractured across Salesforce, Passport Advantage, the w3 directory, Seismic and partner (IFC) systems. To prep a single account a seller manually stitches together install base, renewal and end-of-support dates, org and PO contacts, whitespace and partner coverage. This research is slow, inconsistent between sellers, and goes stale the moment it is written down. Renewals lapse, whitespace goes unworked, and modernization plays are missed - not for lack of pipeline, but for lack of a single trustworthy view.

The solution

IBM Scout models every seller relationship, account, site number, install, opportunity, partner and knowledge asset as a live graph. Every fact carries W3C PROV-DM provenance (source system, confidence, TTL, last-verified). A pruning agent flags stale data before it misleads anyone, and sellers confirm or correct facts through human write-back, so data quality is a shared, decentralized responsibility.

Enterprise graph

Shared org intelligence: People, Accounts & Sites, Products & Installs, Pipeline, Partners, Knowledge - all orbiting one IBM Enterprise Context hub with natural-language search.

Personal graph

Scoped to the signed-in seller: My Book, Next Best Actions, Renewals & EOS, Co-sell network, Quota goals, and writing style for auto-drafted emails.

Who uses it & how

Sellers (CE / SSR / TSL)

Ask "what are my next best actions today?" or "does Louisiana have Cognos on all its sites?" Get an answer, a call-prep Account 360, and a one-click Why-Modernize email in seconds.

Managers & leadership (FLM / SLM / ALT)

See a territory health scorecard, whitespace across the org, and a weekly book digest - all scoped by role via the "View As" entitlement system.

Anticipated outcomes

- ~5 hours per seller per week returned from manual research to active selling.
- Renewal and end-of-support risk surfaced automatically instead of discovered late.
- Consistent, provenance-backed answers every seller can trust and explain.
- Whitespace and modernization pipeline made visible and actionable per book.

HOW IT WORKS

Built with Bob, powered by watsonx

How IBM Bob was used

The entire platform was designed and built through iterative sessions with IBM Bob - no dedicated development team. Bob was used to:

Scaffold the architecture: generate the FastAPI backend, the graph schema (10 node types, 12 relationship types) and the zero-dependency front end from plain-language requirements.

Build the three agents: the ingestion agent (provenance stamping), pruning agent (TTL staleness), and search agent (natural-language to Cypher with a query trace).

Add the intelligence layer: Next Best Actions, whitespace, territory health, Account 360, co-sell match, conflict detection and human write-back - each specified conversationally and refined with Bob across checkpoints.

Iterate on UX: the two-graph enterprise/personal layout, role scoping, and export were all produced and polished with Bob.

Where watsonx.ai Granite powers the product

Natural-language search: Granite interprets a seller's question, the app routes it to intent-specific Cypher, and Granite synthesizes a plain-language narrative answer.

Why-Modernize email drafting: Granite writes a tailored renewal/upgrade email from the install, renewal date, upgrade path and PO contact.

Explainability: every answer shows the model ID, generated Cypher, confidence and the exact edges used - responsible-AI transparency by default.

watsonx Orchestrate: 8 Scout tools are exposed as an Orchestrate skill so sellers can ask from inside their existing assistant.



Why it is differentiated

Most seller tools are static dashboards. IBM Scout is a **living, agent-maintained graph with provenance and human validation** at its core, so answers are current and explainable. It unifies five disconnected IBM systems into one natural-language surface, and it works today in a zero-dependency demo mode - then plugs into live Neo4j and watsonx.ai with only credentials, no rebuild.

Practicality: because it was built entirely with IBM Bob, the incremental build cost was near zero and new capabilities ship in a conversation, not a sprint. The same Bob workflow lets any seller team extend it to their own motions.

Quantified, conservative, scalable

Model assumptions (stated for defensibility): one pilot team of **10 sellers**, **46** productive weeks/year, and an illustrative fully-loaded seller cost of **\$75/hour**. Time estimates are conservative and map directly to the challenge's Solution Impact fields (task, frequency, hours before, hours after).

Repeatable task	Freq / wk	Before	After	Saved / wk
Pre-call account research (Account 360)	4×	45 min	6 min	2.6 hrs
Weekly book review: renewals, whitespace, NBA	1×	90 min	12 min	1.3 hrs
Modernize / follow-up email drafting	3×	18 min	4 min	0.7 hrs
Ad-hoc org, install & partner lookups	5×	10 min	2 min	0.7 hrs
Total per seller				5.3 hrs / wk

5.3 hrs

reclaimed per seller / week

~243 hrs

per seller / year (=6 selling weeks)

2,430 hrs

10-seller pilot / year (=1.3 FTE)

~\$182K

reclaimed capacity / year (pilot)

Revenue protection (illustrative)

Beyond time saved, IBM Scout consolidates **\$3.2M in modernize and at-risk renewal pipeline in the demo book alone** - value that was previously scattered across four systems and easy to miss. Protecting or accelerating even 10% represents **~\$320K of influenced pipeline per book**. Categories addressed: reduce time on routine tasks, reduce time searching for information, improve accuracy/consistency, and reduce operational/renewal risk.

Scale & payback

The pilot math scales linearly. Applied across **1,000 sellers**, the model returns roughly **243,000 hours/year** - **about 130 FTE-years** of selling capacity. Because the platform was built and is extended entirely through IBM Bob, incremental delivery cost stays minimal, so payback is effectively immediate.

Near-term roadmap

- Persist write-back & conflicts to a live store
- NL alert subscriptions ("tell me when...")
- Slate embeddings for lookalike whitespace
- Live Salesforce / PA / w3 / IFC sync

Why it wins

- Practical:** works today, near-zero build cost
- Effective:** ~5 hrs/week, repeatable daily use
- Usable:** ask in plain language, role-scoped
- Innovative:** living, provenance-backed graph